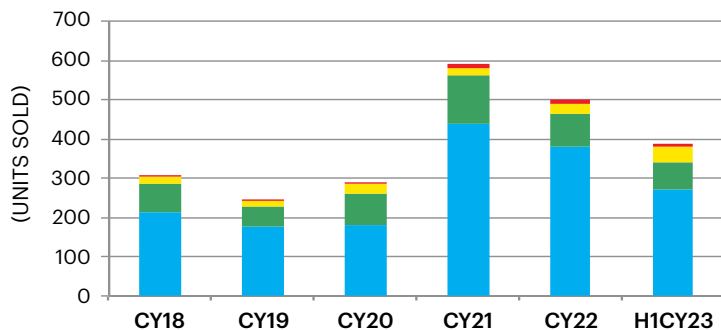


ULTRA-LUXURY IS BACK

▶ In H1CY23, sales of homes in the ₹40-70 crore segment in Mumbai have already exceeded the CY22 tally

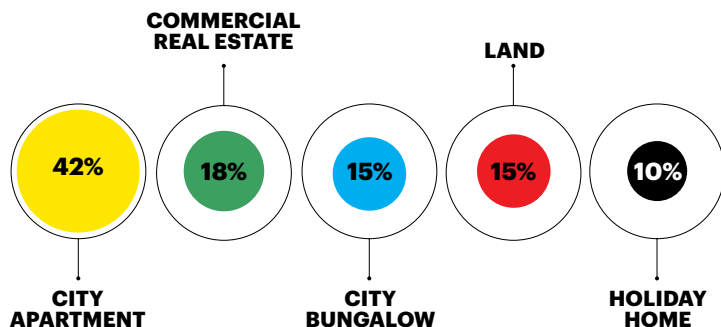


SOURCE SOTHEBY'S MUMBAI LUXURY HOUSING REPORT

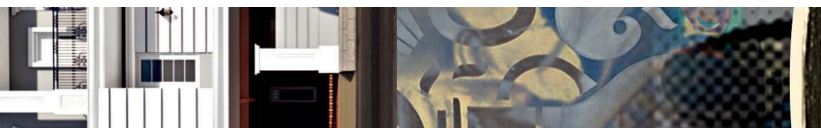
● ₹10-20 CRORE ● ₹20-40 CRORE ● ₹40-70 CRORE ● >₹70 CRORE

CITY LIMITS

▶ Though demand for holiday homes has risen, its share in luxury real estate sales was just 10 per cent



SOURCE SOTHEBY'S LUXURY OUTLOOK SURVEY 2023



LUXURY VILLAS AND MORE

Of course, not all traditional markers of wealth have been shunned—definitely not real estate. Consider this: Earlier this year, Neha Bagaria, the Founder and CEO of Herkey (formerly JobsForHer), 42, bought an apartment in the upscale Malabar Hill area in Mumbai for a cool ₹121 crore.

Indeed, real estate consultancy CBRE South Asia says there has

been a surge in demand for luxury homes—those that have a price tag of ₹4 crore and above. It says luxury home sales in India have jumped a remarkable 130 per cent year-on-year in the first half of 2023 to 6,900 units from 3,000 in 2022.

“Weekend houses, big villas, farm-houses, or bigger apartments are the big preferences for these UHNIs, as they like working from anywhere. We know a lot of our clients who have bought expensive properties outside India in places like Dubai and London,” says Kohli. He says these upwardly and geographically mobile individuals shuttle between the Delhi-NCR region and Goa and Dubai.

Besides, these wealthy individuals are spreading their bets even among foreign real estate markets. Many factors underpin this trend, including the desire to provide a residence for children studying abroad and prestige. “Overseas homes are also gaining popularity, as they offer diversification and, in some cases, the prospect of acquiring citizenship or residency rights, aligning with the broader trend of global investment diversification in the real estate sector,” says Narang.

For instance, in Portugal, purchasing property priced above a certain threshold or acquiring real estate in Dubai grant individuals the chance to obtain permanent residency in those countries.

Equity markets, too, remain an attraction. “Since these founders are astute individuals, they have a strong inclination to gain exposure to direct secondary market equities. This aligns with their desire for hands-on involvement and control in the selection and management of their investments,” says Saigal. He adds that they’re also showing interest in platforms that facilitate investments in baskets of exchange-traded securities.

Clearly, the young and wealthy have realised post Covid-19 that uncertainty is unavoidable and every day is important, which is reflected in their diverse approaches to investment. **BT**

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